

CASE STUDY

Technology & Operating Model Reinvention for Global Air Cargo Carrier



The client fast facts

Company size	\$15B
Industry	Airline
Geography	Global, headquartered in Hong Kong
Reinvention type	Technology implementation, operating model reinvention, and culture change
Duration	More than 3 years

The Ambition

One of the world's leading air cargo carriers faced one of the most complex transformation challenges an airline can undertake: replacing its entire operating system and related applications with a new, integrated technology platform. The project was expected to span more than three years, touching approximately 4,000 staff across headquarters in Hong Kong and over 100 locations globally. For an organization of this scale and operational precision, a technology change of this magnitude was not simply an IT implementation — it was a fundamental shift in how people worked, communicated, and made decisions every day.

The Challenge

The operating system change was unlike anything most affected employees had experienced before. The complexity was not just technical — it was human. Stakeholders across every level of the organization held different views on the challenges with the existing system, different expectations of what the new one would deliver, and different degrees of readiness to change. Without a shared vision and a structured approach to engagement, the risk was not that the technology would fail, but that the organization around it would resist, fragment, or simply not adopt it at the pace the business required.

Solutions Applied

We began by working closely with senior leadership to develop a shared change vision and co-created change journey. From there, we conducted a comprehensive stakeholder analysis, mapping the impact of the system change across the organization and assessing change readiness. We co-designed the change management framework and execution approach with the client project team directly — ensuring full internal ownership from the outset. Central to this was the establishment of a Change Management Center embedded within each impacted department and region, creating a permanent forum for stakeholders to raise concerns, surface practical issues, and contribute to solutions. We then worked alongside the client to design and roll out tailored engagement programs across both headquarters and regional outposts.

Results

- Successful adoption of new operating model
- Measurable shift in employee behavior, with client leadership reporting increased self-motivation, self-initiated programs, and a stronger orientation toward practical, outcome-driven problem solving

We don't transform. **We reinvent.**

At Whitewater Reinventions, we specialise in helping organisations navigate complex processes. Our expert teams provide the insights, strategies and support every business needs to go further than a transformation — to reinvent their organisation for good.

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